

ROOFING ACROSS METROPOLITAN ADELAIDE

Before You Call a Roofer, Read This First

The Adelaide homeowner's guide to a fair quote, a trustworthy roofer, and avoiding costly mistakes.

A free guide from Adelaide Roofers
adelaideroofers.com.au



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Why this guide exists

A new roof is one of the biggest purchases you'll make on your home — often \$15,000 to \$40,000 or more — and one of the hardest to shop for. You can't see inside the work once it's finished. You don't always know if you need a \$600 repair or a \$20,000 replacement. And searching "roofer near me" just hands you a list of ads, with no easy way to tell who actually knows what they're talking about.

This guide covers all of it: understanding your roof, what drives the price, how we vet and refer roofers, what actually happens on the day, and what to check yourself if you'd rather go it alone.

Not sure what your job would cost?

Curious what your own roof job might cost before you read on? It only takes a couple of minutes and there's no obligation.

→ **Try the free instant calculator at adelaideroofers.com.au/calculator**

PART ONE — UNDERSTANDING YOUR ROOF

1

The three roofing materials you'll come across



Terracotta and concrete tile

TYPICAL LIFESPAN: 50+ years for the tiles themselves

The classic Adelaide roof, especially on homes built from the 1950s to 1990s. Tiles are heavy, which helps with noise and insulation, but the material is porous and the mortar bedding ("pointing") that holds ridge caps in place breaks down over time — it typically needs restoration or repointing within 15–20 years, well before the tiles themselves fail.

Best for: Homes with heritage overlays, character-style renovations, and owners who value the traditional look, added thermal mass, and quieter feel in heavy rain.



PART ONE — UNDERSTANDING YOUR ROOF (CONTINUED)



Colorbond and other steel roofing

TYPICAL LIFESPAN: Up to 36-year manufacturer warranty; often lasts longer

A steel core coated in a zinc/aluminium alloy (branded Zinalume) for corrosion resistance, then finished with a baked-on paint layer — this baked-on finish is what "Colorbond" actually refers to, BlueScope's branded painted steel product, not a generic term for any metal roof. It's roughly a third of the weight of tile, comes in 20+ standard colours, and is fully recyclable at end of life. A common myth is that metal roofs are always noisy in the rain — with a properly installed insulation blanket, the difference versus tile is minor for most homes.

Best for: Homes adding solar panels, renovations wanting a lighter roof load, larger or complex rooflines, and owners who want lower long-term maintenance.



PART ONE — UNDERSTANDING YOUR ROOF (CONTINUED)



Asbestos cement sheeting

TYPICAL LIFESPAN: Most installed 1950s–1980s, so already at or past typical service life

Common on homes built before 1987. Asbestos roofing isn't dangerous if it's undisturbed and in good condition, but it becomes a health risk once it starts to crack, crumble, or gets cut or drilled into. Removal must be carried out by a licensed asbestos removalist under strict safety and disposal rules — this is not a DIY or general-handyman job under any circumstances.

Best for: Nothing — this isn't a material you choose for new work. If you have one, the right "best for" is a professional condition assessment.



2

Why roofs actually deteriorate





Adelaide's climate is tougher on roofs than most people realise — hot, UV-intense summers followed by cold, wet winters. Most deterioration comes down to a handful of causes:

- **UV exposure** — constant sun breaks down paint coatings and dries out mortar and sealants over years, even without any single dramatic event.
- **Thermal expansion and contraction** — roofing materials expand in heat and contract overnight; repeated cycles work fixings and joints loose over time.
- **Corrosion** — on older or lower-grade metal roofs, especially where coatings are scratched or where two dissimilar metals touch and react.
- **Blocked gutters and poor drainage** — water that can't drain away sits against roofing materials and fixings, accelerating rust and rot in the surrounding timber.
- **Storm and hail damage** — cracked tiles or dented metal sheeting that isn't repaired promptly lets water in behind the roofing, causing damage that's invisible from the ground.
- **Poor ventilation** — trapped heat and moisture in the roof cavity accelerates wear on the underside of roofing materials and timber framing.

3 How your quote is actually calculated





Two homes with what looks like the same size roof can get very different quotes. That's not necessarily one roofer overcharging — a roofing price is built from several separate factors stacked together:

- **Roof area** — the size in square metres is the base driver of both material quantity and labour time.
- **Pitch and shape** — steep, multi-gabled, or complex rooflines take longer and need more safety equipment (scaffolding, harness systems) than a simple low-pitch rectangle.
- **Material choice** — tile, standard Colorbond, and premium finishes like Matt Colorbond all sit at different price points.
- **Removal and disposal of the old roof** — standard tile or metal removal is one figure; asbestos removal costs significantly more due to specialist handling, sealed disposal, and regulatory requirements.
- **What's underneath** — if battens, purlins, or roof timber are rotten or damaged once the old roof comes off, replacing them adds cost that usually can't be seen until the job has started.
- **Access** — two-storey homes, steep blocks, or tight side access without room for a crane or easy material delivery all add time and cost.
- **Extras** — new guttering, fascia, downpipes, insulation blankets, and ventilation (whirlybirds, sarking) are often bundled into a re-roof and add to the total.

Not sure what your job would cost?

Rather than guess your own number from this list, our free calculator asks for exactly these details — roof size, material, pitch, and rough condition — and builds an estimate the same way a roofer would price a job.

→ **Try the free instant calculator at adelaideroofers.com.au/calculator**

4 How we select and vet a roofer



You shouldn't have to become a licensing expert just to hire someone safely. Every roofer in the Adelaide Roofers network goes through the same checks before we ever refer them to a homeowner — this isn't advice for you to go and do yourself, it's what we've already done before your name and theirs are ever put together.

Before a roofer joins our network, we check:

- **Licensing** — confirmed against South Australia's official Building Work Contractor's Licence register, not just taken on their word.
- **Insurance** — current public liability, building indemnity insurance (BII), and workers compensation cover confirmed, so you're protected if something goes wrong, whether that's damage to your property, an injury on site, or the builder being unable to finish the job.
- **Track record** — real completed local jobs, not just a working phone number.

If a roofer doesn't meet these standards, they're not in our network. Simple as that.

Check any roofer's licence — free

Want to see the same check we run, for any roofer, even one you found yourself? Enter their name or licence number on our free tool and we'll point you straight to South Australia's official register — bookmark it and check as many quotes as you like.

→ adelaideroofers.com.au/verify-a-roofer

PART TWO — COSTS, OUR PROCESS, AND YOUR OPTIONS (CONTINUED)

5 How we refer a roofer — the process

- 1 Tell us your suburb and what's going on with your roof**
Takes about 30 seconds — no lengthy forms, no site visit required just to get started.
- 2 We match you with a vetted, local roofer**
Someone who already covers your suburb and has already passed our licensing, insurance, and track-record checks.
- 3 They contact you directly for a free, no-obligation quote**
No call centre, no middleman haggling, and no pressure to accept.

Why use a referral service?

- 1 We take away the headache**
Instead of ringing five different roofers, chasing quotes, and trying to work out who's legitimate, you tell us once and we do the searching and calling around for you.
- 2 We take away the risk**
Every roofer we refer is already checked against the same standards in Chapter 4 — you're not the one who has to figure out who's licensed and insured.
- 3 Matched to your suburb**
A roofer who actually works your area, not the first ad that shows up in a generic search.
- 4 It costs you nothing**
Our service is completely free to homeowners. We're paid by the roofer, not by you — there's no fee, no catch, and nothing to pay us at any point.

Get matched with a vetted local roofer — free

Tell us your suburb and what's going on with your roof. No cost, no obligation, no call centre.

→ adelaideroofers.com.au

6

What to expect: the physical roofing process, step by step



1

Free quote and inspection

A roofer inspects your roof (or works from photos and measurements for an initial estimate) and provides a written, itemised quote before anything is booked.

2

Material and colour selection

You choose the roofing material, profile, and colour. Lead times vary depending on what's in stock versus made to order.

3

Site preparation

Skip bin delivery, protecting gardens and driveways, and setting up safety barriers, usually the day before or the morning work begins.

4

Removal of the old roof

Usually done section by section rather than all at once, so part of the roof stays weatherproof at every stage of the job.

5

Repairs to the structure

Any damaged battens, purlins, or timber found underneath are replaced before the new roofing goes on — this is the most common source of a revised quote.

PART TWO — COSTS, OUR PROCESS, AND YOUR OPTIONS (CONTINUED)

6

Installation

New roofing sheets or tiles are installed, followed by flashing and ridge capping to seal every join and edge.

7

Gutters and finishing touches

New guttering, downpipes, insulation, or ventilation are installed if they're part of your job.

8

Clean-up and magnetic sweep

The site is cleared of offcuts and packaging, and a magnetic sweep is run over the yard to pick up stray screws and nails.

9

Final inspection and handover

You walk the finished job with the roofer and receive your warranty documentation.



7 Repair, restore, or replace?



Situation	Likely path
A handful of cracked tiles or a single leak, roof otherwise sound	Repair
Roof is structurally sound but faded, chalky, or has moss/lichen build-up	Restoration (clean, seal, repaint)
Repeated leaks in different spots, or repairs needed more than once a year	Getting close to replacement
Roof is asbestos and showing any cracking or deterioration	Replacement (safety, not just cosmetics)
Roof is 40+ years old with widespread wear, or you're planning solar	Replacement usually pays off over patch-repairing

The real cost comparison isn't "repair price vs. replacement price" — it's "repeated repair cost over the next 5 years vs. one replacement now." A roof needing several call-outs a year often costs more over time than a single replacement, without ever actually solving the underlying problem.

8

What actually changes when you go tile-to-metal

- Roughly a third of the weight of tile — less load on your roof structure over time.
- Fewer individual components (large sheets vs. hundreds of tiles) means fewer potential failure points.
- Better suited to solar panel installation — simpler, more secure mounting than tile.
- Broad colour range with a factory-baked finish, rather than a painted-on coating that can chalk and fade.
- A genuine change in the look of the home — worth checking with your council or body corporate if you're in a heritage-listed area before committing.



9

Ask who's actually doing the work

Many roofing companies subcontract the physical installation to third parties, sometimes paid per square metre — an incentive structure that can reward speed over quality. There's nothing automatically wrong with using subcontractors, but you deserve to know before you sign.

Ask directly:

- Will your own employees be doing the work, or a subcontractor?
- If a subcontractor, are they separately licensed and insured?
- Who do I contact if something goes wrong after the job is done?

PART THREE — WHAT TO CHECK YOURSELF (CONTINUED)

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Understand what's actually covered by the warranty

- **Manufacturer's material warranty** — covers the roofing material itself, but is often void if installed by an unlicensed or non-approved installer.
- **Workmanship warranty** — covers the installation itself, and is only as good as the company standing behind it.

Get both warranty periods in writing before work starts, not verbally on the day.



PART THREE — WHAT TO CHECK YOURSELF (CONTINUED)

1
1

Know roughly what you should be paying

Prices vary with roof size, pitch, material, and access, but as a rough guide across metro Adelaide in 2026:

Job type	Typical range (AUD)
Minor repairs (leaks, cracked tiles)	\$300 – \$1,500
Roof restoration (clean, seal, repaint)	\$6,500 – \$10,000+
Tile-to-metal roof replacement	\$15,000 – \$35,000+
Asbestos-to-metal roof replacement	\$18,000 – \$40,000+

A quote wildly below this range is worth asking hard questions about — it usually means a shortcut somewhere: uninsured labour, no permits, or lower-grade material.

Not sure what your job would cost?

These ranges are a starting point, not your number. Get a figure specific to your roof size, material, and suburb in under two minutes.

→ Try the free instant calculator at adelaideroofers.com.au/calculator

PART THREE — WHAT TO CHECK YOURSELF (CONTINUED)

1
2

Red flags to walk away from

- Asks for full payment upfront, before any work has started
- Can't (or won't) give you a licence number
- Pressures you to sign the same day with a "today only" discount
- No fixed address or landline — mobile number only, no way to verify the business
- Turns up unannounced after a storm offering an "inspection" (a common scam pattern after bad weather)
- Quote is verbal only, with nothing in writing

Your 60-second pre-call checklist

- Licence number requested and checked on the SA register
- Proof of current public liability insurance sighted
- Confirmed whether it's their own staff or a subcontractor
- Workmanship warranty period confirmed in writing
- Material warranty terms confirmed (and installer meets manufacturer requirements)
- Written, itemised quote received — not a verbal figure
- Price sits within the expected range for the job type

Conclusion



You now know more about roofs than most people do when they pick up the phone to call one. You understand the materials and how long each one actually lasts, why roofs wear out in the first place, what genuinely drives the price of a quote, how we vet every roofer in our network, and exactly what to check yourself before you let anyone sign a contract on your home.

That's the point of this guide — not to turn you into a roofer, but to make sure you walk into every conversation with a roofing company knowing what a good answer sounds like, and what a red flag looks like, before real money is on the table.

A new roof is a big decision, but it doesn't have to be a stressful or uncertain one. Whether you use this checklist to vet a roofer yourself, or let us do that vetting for you, the goal is the same: you end up with a licensed, insured, local roofer, a fair price, and a roof that's actually built to last.

Or skip the checklist — we've already done it

Every roofer in the Adelaide Roofers network is already checked against this exact list before we ever refer them to a homeowner: licence verified on the SA register, current insurance confirmed, and a real track record of local work. It costs you nothing.

Tell us your suburb and what's going on with your roof, and we'll connect you with a vetted, local roofer — free, with no obligation. Or start with the calculator if you just want a number first.

Get matched with a vetted local roofer

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Check any roofer's licence → adelaideroofers.com.au/verify-a-roofer

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